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PROJECT REPORT

DIGITAL LITERACY (CSE0001)

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Year : 1st
DATE : 26th March 2026

INTRODUCTION

In this project, I take on the role of a Student Digital Ambassador, where my responsibility is to guide and support my peers in understanding how to use digital tools effectively and safely. The main objective of this project is to create a Digital Literacy Portfolio that highlights important digital skills required in today's academic and professional life.

To complete this project, I work on five different tasks, each focusing on a specific area of digital literacy. These include creating an awareness infographic, building a professional online presence using platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn, exploring coding and collaboration tools, learning proper email etiquette, and understanding cybercrime along with ways to prevent it.

Through this project, I gain practical knowledge and improve my confidence in using digital platforms responsibly. It also helps me understand the importance of maintaining a professional online identity and staying safe in the digital world.

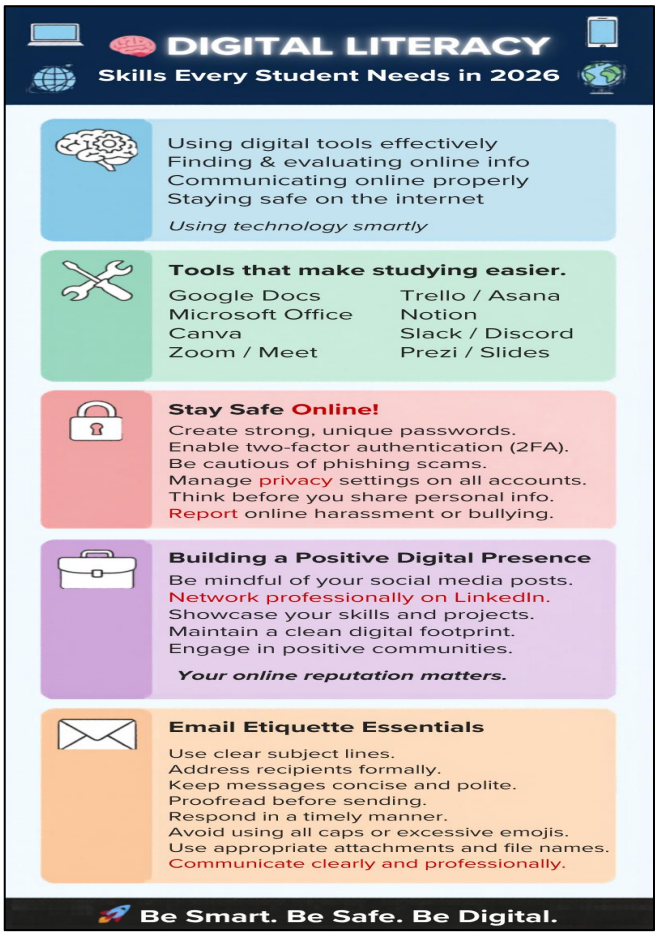
The Scenario

You have just been selected as a Student Digital Ambassador at your college. Your role is to help your peers navigate the digital world — from creating professional online profiles, to communicating safely and responsibly online. Your first assignment is to build a Digital Literacy Portfolio that you will present to the faculty committee and share with your batch.

TASK-1

I created my one-page visual resource using Canva because it is easy to use and helps in making clean designs quickly. My infographic explains what digital literacy is and why it is important for students today. It includes topics like useful digital tools, safe internet practices, maintaining a professional online presence, and proper email etiquette. I used simple words, icons, and different colors so that the information is easy to understand and visually appealing. My aim was to help my batchmates understand how to use technology in a smart, safe, and responsible way.

While working on this, I really enjoyed trying different layouts, icons, and color combinations to make the design look interesting. At the same time, I found it a bit challenging to fit all the important points into one page without making it look too crowded. Overall, this task helped me improve my design skills and taught me how to present information in a clear and creative way.



TASK-2

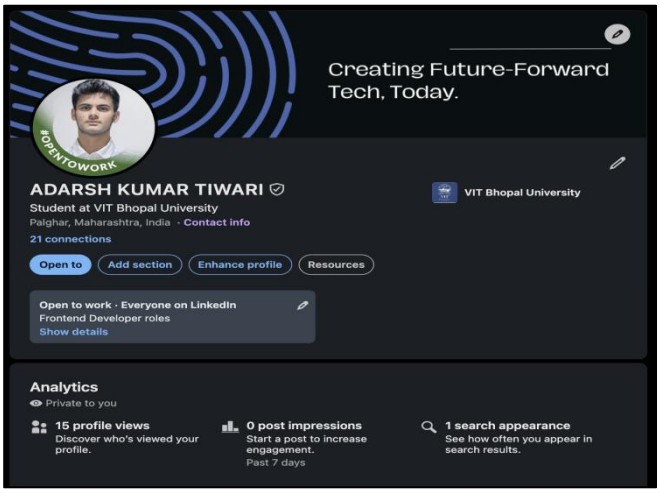
I chose GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle as part of my digital portfolio because they are widely used platforms in the tech and professional world.

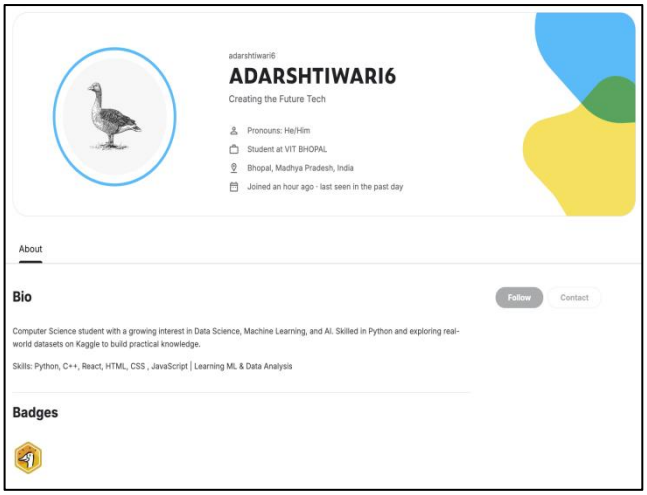
GitHub is mainly used to store and share projects, and I plan to use it to upload my coding work, assignments, and personal projects so that others can see my progress and skills.

LinkedIn is a professional networking platform where I can connect with other students, teachers, and industry professionals. I will use it to build my professional profile, share my achievements, and explore internship opportunities.

Kaggle is a platform focused on data science and machine learning, where users can work on datasets and participate in competitions. I plan to use Kaggle to practice data analysis, improve my problem-solving skills, and learn from real-world datasets.

Over the next four years, I aim to actively use these platforms to build a strong digital presence. By regularly updating my profiles and sharing my work, I hope to improve my skills, gain practical experience, and prepare myself for future career opportunities.



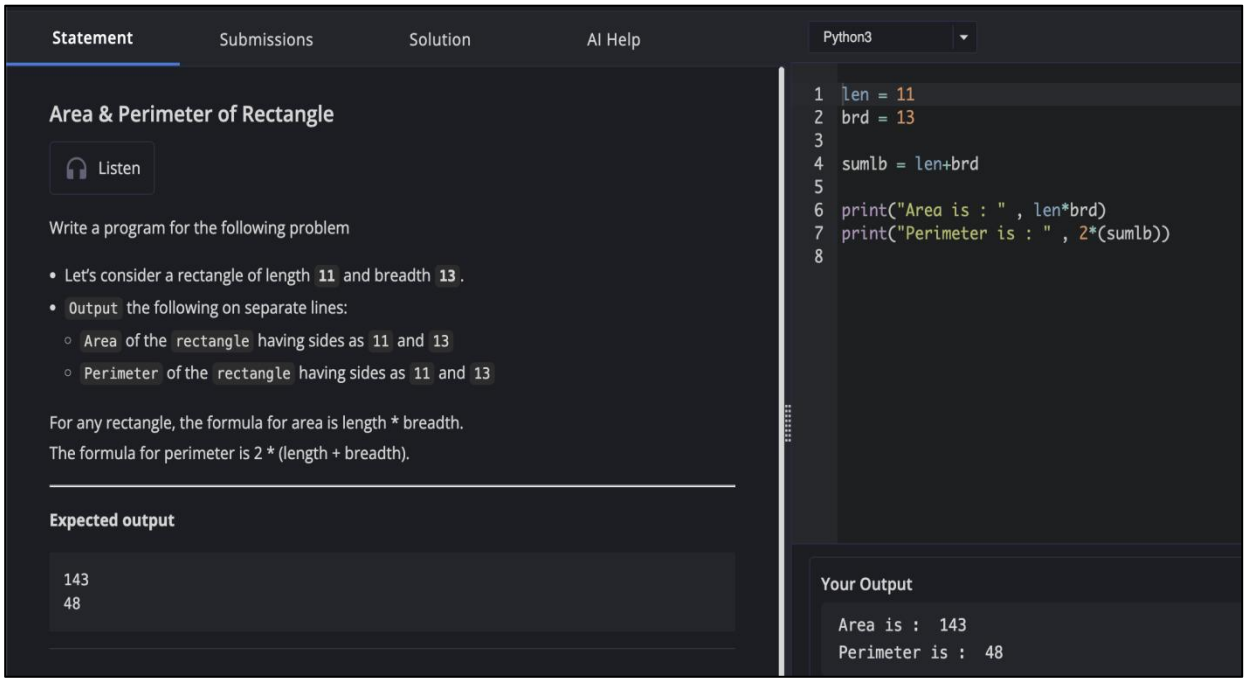


TASK- 3

For this task, I used CodeChef as my coding practice platform and Google Forms for collaboration. On CodeChef, I solved a beginner-level Python problem that involved calculating the area and perimeter of a shape. This helped me revise basic programming concepts such as variables, input/output, and simple calculations. Practicing on CodeChef gave me hands-on experience and improved my confidence in writing and understanding code.

For the collaboration part, I created a Google Form as a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz for my batchmates. This helped me understand how to design questions, collect responses, and organize data using Google Sheets. It also showed me how digital tools can be used effectively for communication and knowledge sharing.

These platforms will help me academically in many ways. Coding platforms like CodeChef will strengthen my problem-solving skills and logical thinking, which are important for exams and technical interviews. Tools like Google Forms will help me in projects, surveys, and teamwork. Overall, these tools will support my learning and help me become more confident in using technology for academic purposes.



TASK- 4

A common example of poor digital communication causing problems is when a student sends an unclear email to a professor about a deadline. For instance, a student might write a vague message like, “I can’t submit on time, please consider,” without mentioning the assignment name, reason, or requested extension date. The professor, receiving many emails, may ignore or misunderstand the request, resulting in a late submission penalty.

This situation could have been handled better with a clear subject line, proper greeting, and complete information. The student should have explained the reason briefly, specified the assignment, and politely requested a new deadline. Using a professional tone and structured format ensures the message is understood and increases the chances of a positive response.

TASK- 5

While researching UPI and online payment fraud, what really surprised me was how easily people can be tricked without any advanced hacking. I always thought cybercrime needed technical skills, but in reality, scammers mostly play with emotions like fear and urgency. Simple messages like “your account will be blocked” can make someone panic and act without thinking. I was also surprised to learn that entering a UPI PIN is only needed to send money, not receive it—something many people, including students, don’t clearly understand.

Because of this, one habit I will change is being more careful before approving any payment request. I won’t rush into actions just because a message feels urgent. Instead, I’ll take a moment to verify who is sending the request and why. I’ll also make sure never to share my UPI PIN or OTP with anyone. Staying calm and double-checking can make a big difference in avoiding such scams.

💳 Case Study: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

UPI (Unified Payments Interface) fraud is a common cybercrime where attackers trick users into transferring money or revealing sensitive banking details. A typical scenario involves a student receiving a call or message from someone pretending to be a bank official or an online buyer/seller.

🔍 How the Fraud Happens

1. The attacker contacts the victim and creates urgency or trust (e.g., “Your account will be blocked”).
2. They send a fake UPI collect request or phishing link.
3. The victim is asked to approve the request or enter their UPI PIN.
4. Entering the PIN actually authorizes a payment from the victim’s account.
5. Sometimes, attackers also ask for OTPs or use screen-sharing apps to gain access.

🎯 Who is Targeted

- Students
- Elderly people
- Users unfamiliar with digital payments

⚠️ Consequences

- Financial loss
- Data theft
- Emotional stress and panic
- Difficulty in recovering money

🚀 Key Takeaway

Never enter your UPI PIN to receive money. Always verify before approving any request.

CONCLUSION

This Digital Literacy Portfolio helped me understand the importance of using technology in a smart, safe, and professional way. Through different tasks, I explored various platforms like GitHub, LinkedIn, Kaggle, and CodeChef, which showed me how digital tools can support both learning and career development. I also learned how to create useful resources like infographics and quizzes to spread awareness among my peers.

One of the most important learnings from this project was the importance of online safety and responsible behavior. Topics like cybercrime, UPI fraud, and social media usage made me realize how easily mistakes can happen and how they can be avoided with basic awareness. Writing professional emails and maintaining a proper online presence also taught me how to communicate effectively in academic and professional environments.

Overall, this project improved my technical skills, creativity, and awareness about digital responsibility. It has encouraged me to be more careful and confident while using online platforms. In the future, I plan to continue using these skills to build my digital profile, improve my knowledge, and help others stay safe and informed in the digital world.

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